



IKS – INDIAN KNOWLEDGE SYSTEMS

UNIT 2 - YOGA BASIC PRACTICES AND PHILOSOPHY

LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR

13th, 20th August, 2025

SCOPE OF STUDY

UNIT 2.1

1. **Maharshi Patanjali**
2. Swami Satyananada Sarawati
3. B.K.S. Iyengar
4. Swami Kuvalayananda
5. Shri Yogendra

UNIT 2.2

1. Body loosening exercises
2. Importance of breath
3. Developing concentration
4. Yoga for mind – body wellness



MAHARSHI PATANJALI

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MAHARSHI PATANJALI



SHANTI PRAYER

Krishna Yajurveda Taittiriya Upanishad (2.2.2)

ॐ सहनाववतु
सह नौ भुनक्तु
सह वीर्यं करवाव है
तेजस्वि नावधीतमस्तु मा विद्विषाव है
ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

Om Saha nāvavatu
Saha nau bhunaktu
Saha vīryam karavāvahai
Tejasvi nāvadhītamastu
Mā vidviṣāvahai
Om Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ

Om, May we all (Teacher and student) be protected
May we all be nourished
May we work together with great energy
May our intellect be sharpened (may our study be effective) ; Let there be no Animosity amongst us
Om, peace, peace, peace

ORIGIN OF YOGA

- The origin of Yoga can be traced to the 'Vedas'. There are references about yoga in the Vedas and the Upanishads
- The practice of yoga is believed to have started at the very dawn of civilization but it is difficult to ascertain a fixed time period for the origin of ancient texts on Yoga since historians differ on the dates when these texts were written
- In yogic lore, Lord Shiva is considered to be the first yogi or **Adiyogi**, and the first Guru or **Adi Guru**
- It was the discovery of the Indus Valley Civilization, that knowledge about the origin of yoga surfaced.
- The development of yoga can be traced back to over 5,000 years ago but some researchers think that yoga may have existed even 10,000 years back

ORIGIN OF YOGA

- Archaeological findings of the Indus Valley Civilization surfaced knowledge about the origin of yoga.
- Yogi-like figures engraved on soapstone seal, verify the existence of yoga culture during this period
- Pashupati seal from Harappa – man in the Siddhasana pose
- Seals and fossil remains of Indus Saraswati Valley Civilization with yogic motifs and figures performing Yoga sadhana



ORIGIN OF YOGA

- Practice of yoga was one of the significant features during this period as seen from the study of the history of Indus valley civilization
- Idols, seals, motifs found in the excavation of the Harappan civilization reveal the trace of yoga culture in the then society
- Maharishi Patanjali is the “ **Father of Yoga**”.
- He compiled the philosophy and practice of Yoga in a systematic and logical way in 200 BC.

HISTORY OF YOGA

Yoga's long rich history can be divided into four main periods of innovation, practice and development. These are:

(i) Vedic Period

- Vedas contain Vedic Yoga

(ii) Pre -Classical Yoga period

- Upanishads contain the aim and essence of Yoga

(iii) Classical Yoga period

- Traditional Yoga – Patanjala Yoga Sutras

(iv) Post-classical Yoga period

- Hatha yoga and other texts of Yoga till date

VEDIC PERIOD

- This period is marked with the emergence of the Vedas
- Vedas were believed to be sacred knowledge revealed to the chosen Rishis due to their virtue of intense penance and are also termed as the **Shrutis**
- Vedas are the infallible word of God and are called as '**Apaurusheya**'
- Vedas form the basis of Hinduism .
- There are four Vedas:
 - (i) Rig Veda - Knowledge of Hymns / Suktas
 - (ii) Yajur Veda - Knowledge of Sacrifice Rituals
 - (iii) Sama Veda - Knowledge of Chants
 - (iv) Atharva Veda - Knowledge of Codes of daily practice

FOUR VEDAS

4 VEDAS	RISHI	4 SECTIONS OF EACH VEDA	SUBJECT	ASHRAMA
RIG VEDA	PAILA	SAMHITA	HYMNS, SUKTAS	BRAHMACHARYA
YAJUR VEDA	VAISHAMPAYAN	BRAHMANA	RITUALS, SACRIFICES (Yajna)	GRIHASTHA
SAMA VEDA	JAIMINI	ARANYAKA	FOREST TREATISE	VANAPRASTHA
ATHARVA VEDA	SUMANTU	UPANISHAD (VEDANTA)	Philosophical Speculations	SANYASA ASHRAMA

INTRODUCTION : Vedangas, Upavedas

- Vedangas help in understanding the Vedas.
- Six Vedangas are
 1. Vyakarana (Grammar)
 2. Shiksha (Phonetics)
 3. Chhanda (Metres)
 4. Nirukta (Etymology)
 5. Jyotish (Astronomy)
 6. Kalpa (Rituals)
- There are four UpaVedas – subsidiary vedas
 1. Rig Veda - Shilpa Veda (Art and Architecture)
 2. Yajur Veda - Dhanur Veda (Military Science)
 3. Sama Veda - Gandharva Veda (Music)
 4. Atharva Veda - Ayur Veda (Medicine)

VEDANGAS

- Six Vedangas are Auxilliaries to Vedas
- Vedangas help to comprehend the essence and spirit of Vedas.
- Veda is considered as PURUSHA by Paniniya Shiksha and His
 - Mouth is Vyakarana
 - Nose is Shiksha
 - Feet are Chhanda
 - Ears are Nirukta
 - Eyes are Jyotish
 - Hands are Kalpa
- The study of Vedas and these six Vedangas helped one to attain knowledge of Brahman, to be one with God and to obtain Salvation

UPAVEDAS

4 VEDAS	SECTIONS	UPAVEDA	SUBJECT	
RIG VEDA	21	SHILPA VEDA	ARTS, ARCHITECTURE	KARMA KANDA
YAJUR VEDA	109	DHANURVEDA	MILITARY SCIENCES	(Action – oriented)
SAMA VEDA	1000	GANDHARVA VEDA	MUSIC	JNANA KANDA
ATHARVA VEDA	50	AYURVEDA	MEDICINE	(knowledge – oriented)

ANCIENT SYSTEM OF LEARNING

Gurukul system in India



- Students stayed and learnt with a Guru the teachings of the Vedas and Upanishads ; acquired skills like archery, medicine
- Guru taught Indian philosophy ; meditation
- Yoga is one of the Indian Philosophy. (Shad-darshanas)
- Philosophy is called Darshana (Root Drish= to see) gives vision of Truth of Ultimate Reality

CLASSICAL YOGA PERIOD

- This period is defined by **Patanjali's Yoga Sutras**
- The Pre – classical period did not clearly define the idea of Yoga and its practices
- The first systematic presentation of Yoga which is written sometime between the 300 and 200 BC
- Patanjali's Yoga Sutras describes the path of **Ashtanga Yoga** – Yoga of 8 Limbs , Kriya Yoga and Abhyasa - Vairagya
- It is often called as “**Classical Yoga**” or “**Traditional Yoga**”
- Patanjali organized the practices of yoga into an “eight-limbed path” containing the 8 steps and stages towards obtaining **Samadhi** or enlightenment.
- The final goal is **Kaivalya** (of delinking Purusha from Prakriti)

YOGA IS ONE OF NAVA - DARSHANAS

	DARSHANA	PROPOUNDER	SCHOOL OF THOUGHT
A	ASTIKA -		ORTHODOX SYSTEMS
1	Nyaya	Gautama Rishi	System of Logic (16 padarthas)
2	Vaisesika	Maharshi Kanada	Atomism (7 categories)
3	Samkhya	Kapila Muni	Cosmic Evolution, Knowledge of Self
4	Yoga	Maharshi Patanjali	Mind Control
5	Mimansa	Jaimini Rishi	Vedic rituals and ethical aspects
6	Vedanta	Maharshi Badarayana Vyasa	Culmination of Upanishadic teachings into Ultimate Reality
B	NASTIKA		HETERODOX SYSTEMS
7	Charvaka	Brihaspati	Materialism
8	Bauddha	Gautama Buddha	Momentariness, non-soul, misery
9	Jaina	Lord Mahavira	Navatattvas, Syadvada, Tri ratnas

MAHARSHI PATANJALI



MAHARISHI PATANJALI PRAYER



योगेन चित्तस्य पदेन वाचां ।
मलं शरीरस्य च वैद्यकेन ॥

योऽपाकरोत्तं प्रवरं मुनीनां ।
पतञ्जलिं प्राञ्जलिरानतोऽस्मि ॥

“I bow down to Muni Patanjali with folded hands who has dispelled the impurities of mind by Yoga; impurities of speech by grammar and impurities of body by treatise on medicine.”

ABOUT SAGE PATANJALI

- Promulgator of Patanjala Yoga Darshana
- Tradition regards him as an incarnation of Adishesha – the Serpent God, vehicle or bed of Lord Vishnu
- Born in Gonarda region, son of Gonika and lived in Naagkupa in Kashi
- He studied in Takshashila University
- Sage Patanjali is complimented by Bhoja as an unique sage who is a
 - Sutrakaar (Patanjala Yogasutras)
 - Bhashyakara (Grammarian - Mahabhashya on Ashtadhyayi)
 - Ayurvedacharya (Physician – Treatise on Ayurveda)
- Sage Patanjali was a great
 - Logician
 - Scientist
 - Psychiatrist
- Sage Patanjali presents an intelligent exposition of tenets of Yoga Philosophy in simple, lucid, elegant language in 195 sutras in 4 padas (Chapters)

BIRTH OF MAHARISHI PATANJALI

- It is believed that :
 - Patanjali is the incarnation of Adishesha, the Lord of Serpents upon whom Lord Vishnu rests.
 - He fell from the heavens (*patan*) into the hands (*anjali*) of a woman named Gonika who was praying for a worthy son to whom she could impart her wisdom. He was a resident of Gonarda region
- A serpent hood over the head with its body coiled around the waist of Maharishi Patanjali is hence seen in his images and statues.
- Scholars tentatively put his time somewhere around second century BC

MAHARISHI PATANJALI

- The origin of Yoga can be traced to the ‘Vedas’.
- There are references about yoga in the Vedas and the Upanishads .
- Maharishi Patanjali is the “ **Father of Yoga**”.
- He compiled the philosophy and practice of Yoga in a systematic and logical way.
- He brought together in the Yoga Sutras the existing knowledge of Yoga in concised form of 195 sutras
- Maharishi Patanjali has acknowledged in the very first Yoga Sutra “*Atha Yoganushasanam*” that he is only the compiler or codifier of Yogic knowledge and not the originator of Yoga

MAHARISHI PATANJALI

- Patanjali studied shastras at Takshashila university
- He became an unparalleled genius in Panini's system of grammar
- Maharishi Patanjali is regarded as the composer of Yoga Sutras.
- Patanjali is Sutrakaar, Bhashyakaar, Ayurvedacharya
- He was a logician, Scientist, Psychiatrist and an unparalleled genius
- In the Yogasutras, Patanjali presents an intelligent exposition of the Yoga tenets starting with the nature and states of Yoga to reach the final emancipation in 195 aphorisms

PATANJALA YOGA SUTRAS

Sage Patanjali compiled the existing knowledge on Yoga into **195** yoga sutras divided into 4 Padas (chapters)

- **Samadhi Pada** – On Concentration - **51** sutras
 - Chitta Vritti Nirodha – by Abhyasa +Vairagya
 - Chitta Vikshepa, Chitta Prasadana
 - Samapatti leads to Samadhi
- **Sadhana Pada** – Means of Practice - **55** sutras
 - Kriya Yoga (Tapa + Swadhyaya + Ishwara Pranidhana)
 - Ashtanga Yoga (Bahiranga Yoga)
- **Vibhuti Pada** – Super normal powers - **55** sutras
 - Antaranga Yoga (Dharana + Dhyana + Samadhi =Samyama)
 - Chitta Parinamas , Samyama leads to Siddhis
- **Kaivalya Pada** – On Liberation -- **34** sutras

PATANJALA YOGA SUTRAS

- Understanding of Patanjala Yoga Darshana
- Chanting of Sutras as each Sutra is like a mantra which have a profound effect on our body and mind
- Sutras are to be chanted, meditated upon to arrive at its true meaning
- Yoga is not merely Asanas and Pranayama as misunderstood by many
- Yoga is an integration of Personality
- Yoga is DOING – practising all 8 angas of Ashtanga Yoga
- Yoga is a Way of Life
- Yoga is a Science – Moksha shastra that Liberates
- Yoga is a Darshana to SEE and experience Reality

MAHABHASHYA OF PATANJALI

In accordance with the tradition Patanjali is also regarded as :

- the author of Mahabhashya – which is a commentary on Panini's Ashthadhyayi (treatise on Sanskrit grammar and linguistics)
- the author of a treatise connected with medicine called Charaka Vaartika, Patanjalah or Patanjalatantra
- A verse quoted in Rajamartanda of King Bhojadeva and also in Vasavadatta tika by Shivarama is the prayer offered to Maharishi Patanjali. It considers Patanjali as the author of all three works (yoga, grammar and medicine).

MAHARISHI PATANJALI

- Maharishi Patanjali was the last saint of Munitraya, the trio of sacred saints with Panini and katyayani
- Maharishi Patanjali is said to have achieved 'Samadhi' through Yogic meditation at the Brahmapureeswarar temple located at Tirupattur, Tirupur, Tamil Nadu
- Jeeva Samadhi of sage Patanjali, which is now an enclosed meditation hall, can be seen near the Brahma's shrine within Brahmapureeswarar Temple complex

SADHANA PADA - 55 SUTRAS

- **Kriyā Yoga** (Tapaḥ, Svādhyāya and Íśvara pranidhāna)
- Description and nature of five kleśas (avidyā, asmita, raga, dvesha and abhinivesha)
- The four-fold way of analysing pain and its removal
- **Aṣṭāṅga Yoga**
 - the five yamas (ahimsa, satya, asteya, brahmacarya and aparigraha)
 - the five niyamas (saucha, santoṣa, tapaḥ, svādhyāya and Íśvarapranidhāna)
 - Definition and effect of physical postures (âsanâ)
 - Breathing practices (prānayama)
 - Withdrawal of senses (pratyahaar)

ASHTANGA YOGA: YOGA OF EIGHT LIMBS

1. **Yama** – Rules of social conduct

2. **Niyama** – Rules of individual conduct

3. **Asana** – Physical postures

4. **Pranayama** – Control of life force /
breathing regulation

5. **Pratyahara** – Withdrawal of senses

6. **Dharana** – Concentration

7. **Dhyana** – Meditation

8. **Samadhi** – Spiritual Absorption

BAHIRANGA YOGA

ANTARANGA YOGA

POST - CLASSICAL YOGA PERIOD

- Post-classical Yoga period refers to Yoga after Classical Period till date. It is marked by a proliferation of literature on Yoga as well as the practice of yoga.
- A few centuries after Patanjali, a number of Yoga masters created a system of practices designed to rejuvenate the body and prolong life - longevity.
- The concept of physical body as the means to achieve enlightenment lead to the development of Tantra Yoga.
- It consists of radical techniques to cleanse the body and mind to break the knots that bind us to physical existence
- This exploration of physical-spiritual connection and body-centered practices led to the creation of what we today understand as **Hatha Yoga, culled out from Tantra.**

YOGA IN MODERN TIMES

- Spread of yoga and yogic culture was triggered by Swami Vivekananda across the globe
- He was disciple of Ramkrishna Paramhansa
- His remarkable lectures in the West, especially in the Parliament of Religions held at Chicago in 1893 evoked interest in Westerners about Yoga
- Yogic tradition received strong inspiration and impetus from great legends in India
- Due to the pioneering efforts of several Yoga Masters like
Guru Swami Shivananda – Disciple Swami Satyananda
Guru Swami Madhavdas – Disciple Swami Kulananda
and Shri Yogendra , yoga flourished in India

YOGA MASTERS IN MODERN TIMES

Babaji Maharaj, Shymacharan Lahiri,

Yukteshwar Giri, Swami Yogananda,

Madhavdas Maharaj,

Swami Kuvalayanandaji (Kaivalyadhama),

T. Krishnamachari (Ashtanga Yoga),

Swami Sivananda (Sivananda Yoga),

B. K. S. Iyengar (Iyengar Yoga),

Shri K. Pattabhi Jois, Shri T. K. V. Desikachar,

Maharishi Mahesh Yogi,

Swami Ramdev (Patanjali Yogpeeth),

Shri Yogendra (The Yoga Institute),

Swami Satyananda (Bihar School of Yoga),

Sri Sri Ravi Shankar (Art of Living), Jaggi Vasudev (Isha Yoga Center),

Swami Rama, Dr. Nagendra H R (SVYASA)



THANK YOU